

HIGHER SECONDARY SECOND YEAR (H.S. 2nd Year)
POLITICAL SCIENCE – 2025 (Code: 35T POSC)

Solved Question Paper (Guide)

Full Marks: 80 (Part-A 40 + Part-B 40) | Time: 3 Hours

Note: As this is a guide, all questions are solved, including every 'OR' / 'Any ____' question.

PART – A : Contemporary World Politics

Q.1 (1 mark each)

Q.1(a) India is a member state of ASEAN. (Yes/No)

Ans:

No.

Q.1(b) Who can exercise the 'veto' power in the Security Council?

Ans:

The five Permanent Members: USA, UK, France, Russia and China.

Q.1(c) Which State is the successor of the Soviet Union?

Ans:

Russia.

Q.1(d) Which country is regarded as the third alternative centre of world power?

Ans:

The European Union (EU); some also consider China/ASEAN.

Q.1(e) Write the full form of SAFTA.

Ans:

South Asian Free Trade Area.

Q.1(f) Which day is celebrated as United Nations' Day?

Ans:

24 October.

Q.1(g) Technology is an important phenomenon of globalisation. (Yes/No)

Ans:

Yes.

Q.1(h) What is Greenhouse gas?

Ans:

Greenhouse gases (carbon dioxide, methane, nitrous oxide, CFCs, etc.) are gases in the atmosphere that trap the sun's heat and cause global warming.

Q.1(i) In which year India successfully tested its first nuclear bomb?

Ans:

1974 (Pokhran, Rajasthan; 18 May 1974).

Q.1(j) What is the full form of WTO?

Ans:

World Trade Organisation.

Q.2 (2 marks each)

Q.2(a) Write the definition of indigenous people given by the UN.

Ans:

The UN's definition (Jose Martinez Cobo's study) says that indigenous peoples are the descendants of the original people who lived in a territory before others came/ colonisation; they:

- have a historical continuity with pre-invasion societies and distinct culture, language and customs;
- consider themselves distinct from the dominant sectors of society and are determined to preserve and pass on their ancestral lands and cultural identity.

Examples: Native Americans, Aboriginal Australians, the tribals of India.

[OR] Q.2(a) Write short note on: Sacred groves in India.

Ans:

Sacred groves are patches of forest or trees protected by local communities on religious grounds, dedicated to local deities or ancestors. They are found in many parts of India (e.g., Meghalaya's 'Law Kyntang', Kerala's 'Kavu', Rajasthan's 'Orans', Western Ghats). They conserve biodiversity, soil and water, and show the traditional ecological knowledge of the indigenous people.

Q.2(b) Mention any two countries in South of India who are the members of SAARC.

Ans:

Sri Lanka and the Maldives.

Q.2(c) Write two causes of disintegration of Soviet Union.

Ans:

- Economic stagnation and inefficiency of the centralised planned economy, along with heavy military spending.
- Rise of nationalism in the republics and Gorbachev's reforms (Glasnost and Perestroika), which weakened the Communist Party's control.

Q.2(d) What is meant by South Asia?

Ans:

South Asia is the region of Asia to the south of the Himalayas, which includes India, Pakistan, Bangladesh, Nepal, Bhutan, Sri Lanka, the Maldives and Afghanistan (SAARC members). These countries share common history, culture, geography and problems like poverty, terrorism and underdevelopment.

Q.2(e) Mention two causes for the failure of stable democracy in Pakistan.

Ans:

- Frequent military coups and rule (Ayub Khan, Zia-ul-Haq, Musharraf) and dominance of the army in politics.
- Lack of a strong political party system and leadership, feudal society, ethnic divisions (e.g., Bengali vs Punjabi), dispute over the Constitution and the role of religion.

Q.2(f) Write the permanent member nations of Security Council.

Ans:

The five Permanent Members of the Security Council are the USA, Russia (earlier USSR), the United Kingdom, France and China. They have the power of veto.

Q.3 (4 marks each)

Q.3(a) Write two arguments in favour of and two arguments against Globalisation.

Ans:

Arguments in favour:

- It increases trade, investment, employment and economic growth, and gives consumers more choice.
- It spreads technology, information and cultural exchange.

Arguments against:

- It widens inequality between and within countries, and local industries and farmers suffer.
- It weakens state sovereignty, harms the environment and threatens local cultures.

Q.3(b) What is the necessity of International Organisation in the world? Explain its role.

Ans:

International organisations like the UN, WTO, IMF, WHO and regional groups (EU, ASEAN, SAARC) are necessary because:

- No single country can solve global problems like war, terrorism, climate change, epidemics and poverty; international cooperation is needed.
- They provide a forum for discussing and peacefully settling disputes between states.

Role:

- Peace and security: the UN keeps peace through the Security Council and peacekeeping forces.
- Economic and social development: the World Bank, IMF and UN agencies give aid; WHO fights diseases; UNESCO and UNICEF help education and children.
- They make international law, protect human rights and encourage cooperation among nations.

Q.3(c) Identify the causes of conflict between India and China and suggest your solutions.

Ans:

Causes of conflict between India and China:

- Boundary dispute (Aksai Chin in the west and Arunachal Pradesh in the east; the McMahon Line) and the 1962 war, with later clashes like Galwan (2020).
- Tibet and the Dalai Lama; China's support to Pakistan (CPEC, arms) and its Belt and Road Initiative; Brahmaputra water issues and trade imbalance.

Suggested solutions:

- Continue dialogue and confidence-building measures on the border and peaceful settlement of the boundary dispute through talks (Special Representatives).
- Increase trade, investment and people-to-people contact; cooperate in BRICS/SCO and on climate change; respect each other's sensitivities.

[OR] Q.3(c) Write a note on European Union.

Ans:

The European Union (EU) is a regional organisation of European countries. It evolved from the European Coal and Steel Community (1951) and the European Economic Community (1957), and was formally established by the Maastricht Treaty (1992).

- It has a single market, a common currency (the Euro, used by 20 countries), its own flag, anthem and a common foreign and security policy; it has a Parliament, Commission and Court of Justice.

- Economic influence: world's large economy and trading bloc. Political influence: acts as a world power and promotes human rights.
- It faced challenges like Brexit (UK left in 2020) and the euro crisis.

Q.3(d) What is the Balance of Power? How can a country maintain this balance?

Ans:

Balance of power means a situation in which no single state or group of states becomes so powerful that it can dominate others; power is distributed more or less equally among major states.

Ways to maintain it:

- Building up military strength and economic power (arms and technology).
- Forming alliances and counter-alliances (e.g., NATO vs Warsaw Pact).
- Diplomacy and use of international organisations, and supporting the weaker side (buffer states).

Q.3(e) How is the relationship between India and Nepal?

Ans:

India and Nepal have close and special relations:

- Treaty of Peace and Friendship (1950) gives an open border, free movement of people and special trade and security ties.
- Cultural, religious and family links (Hindu pilgrimage sites, Buddha's birthplace Lumbini).
- India is Nepal's largest trading partner and gives aid for hydropower, roads and education.
- Irritants: border disputes (Kalapani, Lipulekh), Nepal's Madhesi issue, Nepal's closeness to China, and disagreement on the 1950 treaty.

Q.4 (6 marks each)

Q.4(a) What is the stand of India for environmental issues?

Ans:

India's stand on environmental issues:

- India stresses 'common but differentiated responsibilities': developed countries caused most pollution so they must bear more burden and give technology and finance.
- India has signed the Kyoto Protocol (1997, with exemption as a developing country) and the Paris Agreement (2015) and promised to cut emissions intensity and increase renewable energy (International Solar Alliance).
- India says its per-capita emissions are low, and its priority is development and poverty removal.
- It supports sustainable development and has national laws like the Environment Protection Act (1986) and the National Action Plan on Climate Change.

[OR] Q.4(a) What is the relationship between the rights of indigenous people and environment? Discuss briefly.

Ans:

Indigenous peoples (adivasis, tribals) have lived in close relationship with nature for centuries. The relationship between their rights and the environment is:

- Their livelihood, culture and religion depend on forests, land, rivers and sacred groves; they conserve nature through traditional knowledge.
- Development projects like dams, mining and deforestation displace them, damaging both their rights and the environment.

- Protecting the environment protects indigenous rights; the UN has recognised their rights and the World Council of Indigenous Peoples (1975) works for this.
- Thus, their rights to land and resources are essential for environmental protection.

Q.4(b) What is Shock Therapy? Is this the best way for transition from socialism to capitalism?

Ans:

Shock Therapy was the economic model followed in Russia, Eastern Europe and Central Asia after the collapse of communism in the 1990s, under the guidance of the IMF and World Bank. It meant a sudden shift from the state-controlled socialist economy to capitalism:

- Quick privatisation of state industries, free trade and removal of subsidies, and opening to foreign investment.

Was it the best way?

- No. It was not the best path: the economy collapsed in Russia, industries closed, inflation and unemployment rose, mafia and corruption grew, the rouble fell, and a few became oligarchs while many became poor.
- Some countries like Poland, Czech Republic and the Baltic states benefited in the long term, but the people suffered in the short term; a gradual transition would have been better.

Q.4(c) What is human security? Discuss briefly.

Ans:

Human security means the protection of individuals (not merely states) from threats to their lives and dignity such as hunger, disease, violence and poverty.

- Narrow concept: protecting people from violence (war, terrorism, genocide).
- Broad concept: also includes freedom from hunger, disease, natural disasters and poverty ('freedom from want').
- Threats: war, terrorism, epidemics, refugees/migration, human rights violation and climate change.
- The concept was popularised by the UNDP's Human Development Report 1994.

PART – B : Politics in India Since Independence

Q.5 (1 mark each)

Q.5(a) In which year Bharatiya Janata Party was formed?

Ans:

1980.

Q.5(b) Which Party won the 1977 General Election?

Ans:

The Janata Party.

Q.5(c) Which princely state conducted election on the basis of Universal Adult Franchise for the first time?

Ans:

Travancore (1948). [Please verify this with your textbook.]

Q.5(d) Who was the Prime Minister of India after Pt. Jawaharlal Nehru?

Ans:

Lal Bahadur Shastri (Gulzarilal Nanda was acting PM for 13 days).

Q.5(e) From which year the first Five Year Plan was started?

Ans:

1951 (1951–56).

Q.5(f) What is the full form of EVM?

Ans:

Electronic Voting Machine.

Q.5(g) Who was the chief architect of India's foreign policy?

Ans:

Jawaharlal Nehru.

Q.5(h) When was Sikkim merged with India?

Ans:

1975 (it became the 22nd state of India on 16 May 1975).

Q.5(i) Who was the first non-Congress Prime Minister of India?

Ans:

Morarji Desai (1977, Janata Party).

Q.5(j) When was Assam Movement organised on foreigners' issue?

Ans:

1979 (it started in 1979 under AASU and ended with the Assam Accord in 1985).

Q.6 (2 marks each)

Q.6(a) Explain the concept of 'whip'.

Ans:

A 'whip' is an official of a political party in the legislature who ensures that members attend and vote according to the party's directions. It is also the written order given to members to be present and vote in a particular way on an important issue. If a member defies the whip, he or she may be disqualified under the anti-defection law.

Q.6(b) Write a short note on: White Revolution.

Ans:

The White Revolution (Operation Flood) was a dairy development programme started in 1970 under the National Dairy Development Board (NDDB) led by Dr. Verghese Kurien ('Father of the White Revolution'). It made India the world's largest milk producer, established co-operative societies like Amul (Gujarat), and increased the income of rural farmers and women.

Q.6(c) On which date was the draft of the Indian Constitution signed and when did it come into force?

Ans:

The draft of the Constitution was signed and adopted by the Constituent Assembly on 26 November 1949, and it came into force on 26 January 1950 (Republic Day).

Q.6(d) Mention two objectives of Nehru's foreign policy.

Ans:

- To preserve India's sovereignty and territorial integrity, and promote world peace through non-alignment.
- To oppose colonialism and racism and to support Afro-Asian unity and cooperation.

Q.6(e) Write a note on NDA.

Ans:

The National Democratic Alliance (NDA) is a coalition of political parties in India, led by the BJP. It was formed in 1998 under Atal Bihari Vajpayee, who became the PM (1998–2004). After 2014, it came to power under Narendra Modi, and the NDA formed the government again in 2019 and 2024. Its constituents include the TDP, JD(U), Shiv Sena (Shinde), etc.

Q.6(f) Why was the State Reorganisation Commission set up?

Ans:

The States Reorganisation Commission (SRC) was set up in 1953 (members: Fazl Ali, K.M. Panikkar and H.N. Kunzru) to reorganise states on linguistic lines because of the demand for linguistic states after the death of Potti Sriramulu (Andhra movement). It submitted its report in 1955, and the States Reorganisation Act (1956) created 14 states and 6 Union Territories.

Q.7 (4 marks each)

Q.7(a) How did the fourth General Elections in 1967 change the dynamics of Indian politics?

Ans:

The 1967 fourth general election changed Indian politics in these ways:

- The Congress lost its absolute dominance: it got only a narrow majority in the Lok Sabha (283 of 520 seats) and lost power in 8 states (Punjab, Haryana, UP, Bihar, West Bengal, Orissa, Madras, Kerala).
- Coalition governments (Samyukta Vidhayak Dal) of non-Congress parties emerged in many states, and the era of coalition politics began.
- The Congress split in 1969 and defections and instability increased; the election showed the end of the 'Congress System' (the first stage) and the rise of regional parties (like DMK in Madras).

Q.7(b) Write four features of India's coalition government.

Ans:

Features of coalition government in India:

- Two or more parties join together to form the government, since no single party has an absolute majority in the Lok Sabha.
- A Common Minimum Programme or an agreed agenda is made (e.g., UPA 2004).
- Regional parties play an important role and enjoy a bargaining power; ministerial posts are shared.
- Decisions are slower and the government can be unstable (e.g., 1990s), as parties may withdraw support; the Prime Minister has less power than in a majority government.

Q.7(c) How can the problem of Regionalism be solved?

Ans:

Regionalism can be solved by:

- Balanced regional development: removing economic disparities so that no region feels neglected.
- Strengthening federalism: giving states more powers and finance, and respecting the demands of regions democratically (e.g., reorganisation of states).
- Promoting national integration through education, media and cultural exchange ('unity in diversity'); accommodating regional parties in power.
- Better working of democracy, addressing linguistic and tribal demands through autonomy (Sixth Schedule), and political dialogue.

[OR] Q.7(c) Give a brief note on Jammu-Kashmir.

Ans:

Jammu and Kashmir joined India in October 1947 when Maharaja Hari Singh signed the Instrument of Accession after the tribal invasion from Pakistan. Article 370 gave it special status. The issue was taken to the UN by India (1948); the ceasefire line later became the Line of Control. Pakistan occupies part (PoK). Militancy increased from 1989. In August 2019 the Government of India abrogated Article 370 and reorganised the state into two Union Territories: Jammu & Kashmir (with legislature) and Ladakh.

Q.7(d) What were the causes for mid-term election in 1980?

Ans:

Causes of the mid-term election in 1980:

- The Janata government (1977–79) collapsed due to internal quarrels among its leaders (Morarji Desai, Charan Singh, Jagjivan Ram) and the dual membership issue (Jana Sangh/RSS).
- Charan Singh formed a government with Congress support but Indira Gandhi withdrew it before he could face Parliament.
- With no alternative government, Lok Sabha was dissolved and elections held in January 1980; Congress (I) won and Indira Gandhi returned to power.

[OR] Q.7(d) Who announced Twenty Point Programme and why?

Ans:

The Twenty Point Programme was announced by Prime Minister Indira Gandhi on 1 July 1975 (soon after the Emergency).

Why: to show that the Emergency was meant for the welfare of the poor and for economic development. It included land reforms, abolition of bonded labour, minimum wages for farm labour, housing for the poor, cancellation of rural debts, and improvements in tax collection and control of prices.

Q.7(e) What is Green Revolution? Discuss the economic and political outcome of Green Revolution.

Ans:

The Green Revolution was the introduction of high-yielding variety (HYV) seeds, chemical fertilisers, pesticides and irrigation in the 1960s, led by M.S. Swaminathan and Norman Borlaug, mainly in Punjab, Haryana and western Uttar Pradesh (wheat and rice).

Economic results:

- Food grain production increased greatly and India became self-sufficient; farmers' incomes rose and the rural economy grew.
- However, regional inequality (only some states) and inequality between rich and poor farmers increased; the environment was harmed (soil and groundwater damage).

Political results:

- The rich/middle peasantry became politically powerful (farmers' movements like BKU), and Congress strengthened its rural base.
- Poor peasants and landless labourers got less benefit, which led to rural conflicts and radical Leftist movements (Naxalite).

Q.8 (6 marks each)

Q.8(a) When was the Bharatiya Jansangha formed? Discuss its ideologies.

Ans:

The Bharatiya Jana Sangh was formed in 1951 by Syama Prasad Mukherjee (with support from the RSS). Its ideologies were:

- Cultural nationalism: 'one country, one culture and one nation' and emphasis on Indian culture and Hindi.
- Akhand Bharat: opposition to partition and to the special status of Jammu and Kashmir (Article 370).
- A Uniform Civil Code and a ban on cow slaughter; opposition to the policy of 'appeasement' of minorities.
- A strong defence policy, including the development of nuclear weapons; opposed Nehru's economic policies for a freer market. It merged into the Janata Party in 1977 and re-emerged as the BJP in 1980.

[OR] Q.8(a) Analyse comparatively about the nature of Congress dominance in India.

Ans:

Nature of Congress dominance in India (comparative analysis):

- Congress dominance 1952–1967: the Congress won the first three general elections with a large majority, being a 'dominant party' in a competitive system; the opposition was weak and divided. The 'Congress system' (Rajni Kothari) was a one-party-dominant system within a democracy, unlike the one-party rule in the USSR/China or Mexico's PRI, because here elections were free and competitive.
- Compared with other countries: in Mexico, the PRI ruled through control; in China the Communist party rules without competition; whereas in India, Congress won through free elections, with opposition parties and a free press.
- Factors: the legacy of the freedom movement, the inclusive 'rainbow' nature, and Nehru's leadership; the FPTP system also helped it.
- Decline: after 1967 its dominance reduced, coalition politics emerged after 1989, and the BJP has been dominant since 2014.

Q.8(b) What are the main considerations of the merger of Princely State with United India? Who played historical role in it?

Ans:

Considerations for the merger of princely states:

- Unity and territorial integrity of India: about 565 princely states, if independent, would have threatened India's unity after Partition.
- Geographical location, the people's wish for democracy and the demand of the people of these states to join India.
- Security and economic reasons: the small states could not survive alone.

Historical role:

- Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel (Deputy PM and Home Minister) with V.P. Menon, Secretary of the States Department, persuaded most rulers through the Instrument of Accession; Junagadh, Hyderabad (Operation Polo, 1948) and Kashmir needed special action.

Q.8(c) What is Foreign Policy? Explain briefly.

Ans:

Foreign policy is the set of principles and policies followed by a country in its relations with other countries to protect national interest. It includes the objectives (security, economic development, international prestige), and instruments like diplomacy, trade, military and alliances. India's foreign policy is based on non-alignment, Panchsheel, peace and cooperation, and opposition to colonialism; Nehru was its chief architect.

[OR] Q.8(c) Write a note on non-alignment in India's foreign policy.

Ans:

Non-alignment was the basic principle of India's foreign policy under Nehru. It meant not joining either the US-led or Soviet-led military blocs during the Cold War and keeping independence in foreign policy.

- It was not neutrality or isolationism: India actively worked for peace and took positions on international issues.
- Reasons: to protect sovereignty, focus on development, and maintain friendly relations with both blocs. India founded NAM in 1961 (with Tito, Nasser, Sukarno and Nkrumah).
- After the Cold War its meaning changed, but India still follows 'strategic autonomy'.

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